

Job Title:	Support Assistant
Responsible to:	Student Basic Needs Coordinator
Department:	Community, Advice & Support
Hours:	Able to work a minimum of 4 hours per week during term time. There is some limited work available in vacation periods.
Start Date:	Please note, this role starts in September 2026 and runs throughout the next academic year.

Outline of Post:

With the Community, Advice & Support team, Support Assistants will help ensure key wellbeing initiatives run smoothly. These include Cost of Living projects such as our Community Breakfasts and Pantry and finance information campaigns, as well as Harm Reduction initiatives. Harm Reduction is about raising awareness and education for students around drugs and alcohol, and how to keep safe generally whilst at university.

The role is wide ranging, from collecting donations for Community Pantry, to assisting at events, and talking to students via outreach. You will be part of strengthening the Guild's contribution to our members' wellbeing, helping students feel they belong to a supportive and welcoming community.

Duties and Responsibilities:

1. To assist in the delivery of departmental activities, including supporting the Community Pantry and Community Breakfasts.
2. To support a wide range of projects and events in the Guild and across campus.
3. To carry out the physical aspects of the role, including walking between donation points, carrying supplies for events, and setting up and taking down event spaces.

4. Advocate for Cost of Living, Harm Reduction, and wider student wellbeing campaigns by sharing key messages, supporting social media activity, and delivering in-person campaigning through events and outreach.
5. To confidently engage with students and stakeholders (e.g. University staff and external charity partners) on campaign topics.
6. Maintain appropriate boundaries and follow established procedures, ensuring students are safely signposted to relevant support services if they disclose concerns or any distress related to the topics discussed.
7. Work respectfully with students from a wide range of backgrounds, including those experiencing financial pressures or wellbeing challenges.
8. Attend and commit to ongoing training and regular 1:1 supervision.
9. Carry out other duties which fall within the reasonable expectations of the post.
10. Observe Guild health and safety procedures, always working safely, and reporting any potential hazards, faults, or issues to Guild staff immediately.
11. To maintain a flexible and pragmatic approach to working duties and times.
12. To portray a positive image of the Guild both internally and externally, and set high standards of personal integrity and professionalism, leading by example.

Person Specification

The person specification describes the knowledge, experience & abilities that the Guild is looking for in the student staff we employ. To be successful, during the selection process (application form & interview) you should demonstrate:

- Strong communication skills, able to confidently engage with students and Guild/University staff to promote activities and encourage involvement.
- Strong organisational skills to ensure smooth and impactful event / activity delivery.
- Advocacy and leadership to empower others and drive positive change.
- Willing to engage with training on wellbeing, harm reduction, and signposting.
- Able to work in a team and on own initiative, and to resolve minor issues during events and outreach.
- Able to stay calm and problem solve under pressure.
- Empathy and approachable nature.
- An understanding of equality, diversity and inclusive communication.
- An understanding of social media and content creation, including featuring in videos and posts.
- Flexibility, commitment and punctuality.
- Ability to balance academic work with your responsibility to the Guild as your employer throughout the academic year.
- Comfortable with manual handling.
- Strong customer service focus with an awareness of your impact on the customer experience.